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CONSTITUTION OF THE DeKUT GIKUYU STUDENT ASSOCIATION

We, the members of **The DeKUT Gikuyu Students Association**, students of **Dedan Kimathi University of Technology**, guided by the values of unity, identity, integrity, and mutual responsibility, do hereby establish this Association.

Inspired by the spirit of **Mumbi**, the mother of the Kikuyu people, we come together to preserve our shared heritage, promote moral uprightness, foster leadership, and support the academic, social, and economic well-being of our members. We recognize the importance of culture as a foundation for identity, discipline, and responsible citizenship within the university and the wider society.

This Association exists to unite students of Kikuyu heritage from Central Region and all other counties in Kenya, while upholding respect for diversity, peaceful coexistence, and adherence to the laws and regulations of Dedan Kimathi University of Technology and the Republic of Kenya.

Vision

To be a united, principled, and influential student association that nurtures culture, leadership, and excellence among its members.

Mission

To promote unity, cultural awareness, moral values, mentorship, and socio-economic empowerment of members through organized activities, leadership development, and collective responsibility.

Core Values

The Association shall be guided by the following core values:

- Unity and solidarity
- Loyalty
- Integrity and moral discipline
- Respect for culture and diversity
- Leadership and service
- Accountability and responsibility
- Mutual support and inclusivity

We therefore adopt, enact, and commit ourselves to this Constitution as the supreme guiding document of **The DeKUT Gikuyu Students Association**.

CHAPTER ONE

NAME, STATUS AND LOCATION

Article 1: Official Name of the Association

1. The name of the Association shall be DeKUT GIKUYU STUDENTs ASSOCIATION.
 2. The Association shall operate under this name in all its activities, documents, correspondence, and representations within and outside the University.
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Article 2: Legal Status

1. The Dekut Gikuyu Students Assosiaton is a **non-profit student association**.
 2. The Association is established in accordance with the **laws of the Republic of Kenya** and shall operate in compliance with the **rules, regulations, and policies of Dedan Kimathi University of Technology** governing student organizations.
 3. The Association shall not pursue objectives or engage in activities inconsistent with the University's mandate, public order, or national laws.
 4. The Association shall have no legal personality separate from the University and shall function under the supervision and approval of the relevant University authorities.
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Article 3: Area of Operation

1. The Association shall operate primarily within **Dedan Kimathi University of Technology**, including all campuses, hostels, and officially recognized University spaces.
2. The Association may, with prior approval from the relevant University authorities, conduct activities outside the University where such activities advance the objectives of the Association.
3. Membership and participation in the Association shall be open to eligible students of Dedan Kimathi University of Technology regardless of their county of origin, provided they identify with and subscribe to the values, objectives, and Constitution of the Association.

CHAPTER TWO

OBJECTIVES AND FUNCTIONS OF THE ASSOCIATION

Article 4: Objectives of the Association

The objectives of DeKUT Gikuyu Students Association shall be to:

1. Unite students of Kikuyu heritage within Dedan Kimathi University of Technology in the spirit of brotherhood, sisterhood, and collective identity.
2. Promote, preserve, and celebrate Kikuyu culture, values, traditions, and heritage in a manner consistent with the laws of Kenya and University regulations.
3. Foster moral uprightness, discipline, mutual respect, and responsible conduct among members.
4. Promote academic excellence, mentorship, and personal development of members through guidance, peer support, and capacity-building initiatives.
5. Encourage leadership development and civic responsibility among members for the benefit of the University and society at large.
6. Promote unity, peaceful coexistence, and collaboration with other student associations and communities within the University.
7. Enhance the social and economic welfare of members through collective initiatives, networking, and empowerment programs.

Article 5: Functions of the Association

In pursuit of its objectives, the Association shall perform the following functions:

1. Organize cultural, educational, social, and mentorship activities aimed at strengthening unity and identity among members.
2. Provide a platform for dialogue, consultation, and collective action on matters affecting the welfare of members.
3. Facilitate leadership training, seminars, and forums to nurture responsible and ethical student leaders.
4. Support academic and career development initiatives, including peer mentorship, alumni engagement, and skills development.
5. Promote community service and social responsibility activities in line with University policies.
6. Collaborate with other student associations, University organs, and external partners where such collaboration aligns with the objectives of the Association.
7. Mobilize resources, subject to University approval, to support the lawful activities and programs of the Association.

CHAPTER THREE

MEMBERSHIP

Article 6: Eligibility for Membership

1. Membership of **The DeKUT Gikuyu Students Association** shall be open to all **bona fide students of Dedan Kimathi University of Technology** who are of Kikuyu heritage from the Republic of Kenya.
 2. A member shall be eligible for membership upon:
 - a) Being a registered student of Dedan Kimathi University of Technology; and
 - b) Expressing willingness to uphold this Constitution and the objectives of the Association.
 3. No person who is not a student of Dedan Kimathi University of Technology shall qualify for membership of the Association.
-

Article 7: Categories of Membership

The Association shall have the following categories of membership:

1. **Ordinary Members**
 - These shall be registered students who meet the eligibility criteria and have been duly admitted into the Association.
2. **Alumni members**
 - These shall be registered students who were initially ordinary members but graduated after the end of their undergraduate programs.

Article 8: Rights of Members

Every registered DeKUT Gikuyu Students Association shall have the right to:

1. Participate fully in all lawful activities, programs, and events of the Association.
2. Attend, contribute, and vote in General Meetings of the Association, subject to compliance with this Constitution.
3. Elect and be elected to leadership positions of the Association, provided such member meets the eligibility requirements set out in this Constitution and University regulations.
4. Access information relating to the activities, finances, and administration of the Association in a transparent manner.

5. Express opinions, raise concerns, and make proposals through established Association organs without fear of discrimination or victimization.
 6. Enjoy equal treatment and protection under this Constitution, regardless of county of origin, gender, or social status.
 7. Withdraw from membership of the Association voluntarily in accordance with the provisions of this Constitution.
-

Article 9: Loss and Termination of Membership

A member shall cease to be a member of the Association if:

1. He or she ceases to be a student of Dedan Kimathi University of Technology.
2. He or she voluntarily resigns from the Association by written notice to the Secretary.
3. He or she is expelled from the Association following disciplinary action in accordance with this Constitution and University regulations.
4. He or she acts in a manner inconsistent with the objectives, values, or Constitution of the Association.

CHAPTER FOUR

LEADERSHIP AND GOVERNANCE

Article 9: Organs of the Association

The Association shall have the following organs:

1. The **General Assembly**
 2. The **Executive Committee**
 3. Such **Committees or Ad hoc bodies** as may be established in accordance with this Constitution.
-

Article 10: The General Assembly

1. The General Assembly shall be the **supreme organ** of the Association and shall comprise all registered members.
2. The powers and functions of the General Assembly shall include:
 - a) Formulating policies and giving general direction to the Association;
 - b) Electing and removing members of the Executive Committee;
 - c) Approving amendments to this Constitution;
 - d) Receiving and approving reports from the Executive Committee;

- e) Making decisions on any matter affecting the Association.
 - 2. Decisions of the General Assembly shall be made by a **simple majority**, unless otherwise provided in this Constitution.
-

Article 11: The Executive Committee

1. The Executive Committee shall be the **principal administrative and management organ** of the Association.
 2. The Executive Committee shall be responsible for implementing decisions of the General Assembly and managing the day-to-day affairs of the Association.
 3. The Executive Committee shall be accountable to the General Assembly.
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Article 12: Composition of the Executive Committee

The Executive Committee shall consist of the following elected officials:

1. Chairperson
2. Vice-Chairperson
3. Secretary General
4. Treasurer
5. Organizing Secretary
6. Sports and Entertainment
7. Communication Director

Any other official as may be approved by the General Assembly, subject to University regulations.

Article 13: Functions of Executive Committee Officials

1. Chairperson

The Chairperson shall be the principal leader and spokesperson of the Association and shall:

1. Provide overall leadership and strategic direction to the Association.
2. Preside over all General Assembly and Executive Committee meetings.
3. Represent the Association in official engagements within and outside the University, subject to approval.
4. Ensure that the activities and decisions of the Association comply with this Constitution and University regulations.

5. Oversee the implementation of policies and resolutions passed by the General Assembly.
 6. Promote unity, discipline, and cohesion among members of the Association.
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2. Vice-Chairperson

The Vice-Chairperson shall:

1. Assist the Chairperson in the execution of their duties.
 2. Act on behalf of the Chairperson in their absence or incapacity.
 3. Perform any other duties as may be delegated by the Chairperson or the Executive Committee.
 4. Support coordination among Executive Committee members.
-

3. Secretary General

The Secretary General shall be the chief administrative officer of the Association and shall:

1. Be responsible for all official correspondence of the Association.
 2. Prepare and keep accurate records, minutes, and documentation of all meetings.
 3. Maintain the membership register of the Association.
 4. Issue notices for meetings and communicate resolutions to members.
 5. Ensure proper custody of all Association records and documents.
 6. Advise the Executive Committee on constitutional and procedural matters.
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4. Treasurer

The Treasurer shall be the chief financial officer of the Association and shall:

1. Manage and safeguard all funds and financial assets of the Association.
 2. Keep accurate and up-to-date financial records and books of accounts.
 3. Present financial reports to the Executive Committee and General Assembly.
 4. Ensure that all expenditures are authorized and properly accounted for.
 5. Facilitate budgeting and financial planning for Association activities.
 6. Ensure financial transparency and accountability in accordance with this Constitution and University regulations.
-

5. Organizing Secretary

The Organizing Secretary shall:

1. Plan, coordinate, and oversee the implementation of Association events and activities.
 2. Mobilize members for meetings, programs, and activities of the Association.
 3. Work closely with other officials to ensure smooth execution of events.
 4. Manage logistics and coordination during Association functions.
 5. Perform any other duties as may be assigned by the Executive Committee.
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6. Sports and Entertainment Secretary

The Sports and Entertainment Secretary shall:

1. Plan, organize, and coordinate sports, recreation, and entertainment activities for members.
2. Promote physical fitness, talent development, and social interaction among members.
3. Organize cultural, entertainment, and social events in line with the objectives of the Association.
4. Collaborate with other student bodies in organizing sports and entertainment activities, subject to approval.
5. Use sports and entertainment as tools for unity, wellness, and member engagement.

7. Communication Director

The Communication Director shall be responsible for all internal and external communication of the Association and shall:

1. Develop and manage the Association's communication strategy in line with its objectives and values.
2. Serve as the official custodian of the Association's public image and messaging.
3. Manage all official communication platforms of the Association, including social media, notices, and digital forums.
4. Ensure timely, accurate, and consistent dissemination of information to members regarding meetings, activities, and decisions.
5. Document Association activities through reports, photography, and other approved media for record-keeping and publicity.
6. Work closely with the Chairperson and Secretary General in preparing official statements, announcements, and publications.
7. Promote unity, positive engagement, and responsible communication among members.

8. Perform any other communication-related duties as may be assigned by the Executive Committee.

Article 14: Committees

1. The executive committee may establish standing or ad hoc committees to carry out specific functions.
 2. Committees shall operate under the authority of the Executive Committee and report to it.
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Article 15: Tenure of Office

1. Members of the Executive Committee shall hold office for **one academic year**.
2. An official shall be eligible for re-election subject to University regulations.

CHAPTER FIVE

ELECTIONS AND VOTING PROCEDURES

Article 16: Electoral Principles

1. Elections of officials of DeKUT Gikuyu Students Association shall be conducted in a **free, fair, transparent, and democratic manner**.
 2. All elections shall be held in accordance with this Constitution and the rules and regulations of Dedan Kimathi University of Technology.
 3. Every eligible member shall have the right to participate in the electoral process without discrimination.
-

Article 17: Eligibility for Election

1. A member shall be eligible to vie for an elective position if he or she:
 - a) Is an active member of the Association by showing up in meetings;
 - b) Is a bona fide student of Dedan Kimathi University of Technology;
 - c) Is in good disciplinary standing with the University and the Association;
2. No member shall hold more than one elective office at the same time.
3. No person shall serve more than 2 terms in any elective position

Article 18: Electoral Body

1. The elections shall be conducted by an **Independent Electoral Committee** appointed by the Executive committee.
2. The Electoral Committee shall be responsible for:
 - a) Nominations and vetting of candidates;
 - b) Conducting elections;
 - c) Declaring and announcing election results.
3. The Electoral Committee shall be impartial and accountable to the General Assembly.

Article 19: Voting Procedure

1. Voting shall be conducted through **secret ballot** within the first 4 weeks of January
2. Each eligible member shall have **one vote** per elective position.
3. A candidate shall be declared elected upon obtaining a **simple majority** of valid votes cast, unless otherwise provided by University regulations.
4. The Aspirants shall form coalition which they shall be elected under.
5. The coalition must compose of members from different counties.

Article 20: Tenure and Assumption of Office

1. Elected officials shall hold office for **one academic year**.
2. Newly elected officials shall assume office immediately upon declaration of results.

Article 21: By-Elections and Vacancies

1. A vacancy shall arise if an official:
 - a) Resigns;
 - b) Ceases to be a student of the University;
 - c) Is removed from office in accordance with this Constitution; or
 - d) Is unable to perform duties for a prolonged period.
2. Such vacancy shall be filled through a **by-election or appointment**, as approved by the remaining executive committee members .

Article 22: Grounds for Removal

An elected official of The DeKUT Gikuyu Students Association may be removed from office before the expiry of their tenure under any of the following circumstances:

- a) Violation of the Constitution, rules, or regulations of the Association or Dedan Kimathi University of Technology;
- b) Engaging in misconduct, abuse of office, or actions that bring the Association into disrepute;
- c) Gross negligence, incompetence, or failure to perform the duties of the office;
- d) Conviction of a criminal offense or involvement in activities inconsistent with the values of the Association;
- e) Persistent absenteeism from official duties or meetings without valid justification;
- f) Loss of eligibility, including withdrawal from the University or expulsion from the Association.

The procedure for removal shall be as follows:

1. A written notice of the alleged grounds for removal shall be submitted to the General Assembly or a designated disciplinary committee.
2. The concerned official shall be given an opportunity to respond to the allegations.

CHAPTER SIX

FINANCE AND ASSET MANAGEMENT

Article 23: Sources of Funds

The funds of DeKUT Gikuyu Students Association shall be derived from the following sources:

- a) Fundraising activities approved by the Association and University authorities;
- b) Donations, grants, and sponsorships from individuals or organizations, subject to University regulations;
- c) Income generated from lawful Association activities and events;
- d) Any other lawful source approved by the General Assembly and relevant University authorities.

All sources of funds shall be consistent with the objectives of the Association and University policies.

Article 24: Use of Funds

Funds of the Association shall be used strictly for:

- a) Implementation of the objectives and activities of the Association;
- b) Financing approved programs, events, and projects;
- c) Administrative and operational expenses of the Association;
- d) Welfare and development initiatives for members as approved by the General Assembly.

No funds shall be used for personal benefit of any member or official of the Association.

Article 25: Financial Management and Accountability

The Treasurer shall be responsible for the proper management of the Association's finances under the oversight of the Executive Committee.

All financial transactions shall be properly documented and supported by receipts or relevant records.

The Treasurer shall prepare and present:

- a) Periodic financial reports to the Executive Committee; and
- b) An annual financial report to the General Assembly.

The financial records of the Association shall be open for inspection by members upon reasonable notice and in accordance with this Constitution.

Article 26: Bank Accounts and Signatories

The Association shall operate an official bank account approved by Dedan Kimathi University of Technology.

The bank account shall have **at least three signatories**, namely:

- a) The Chairperson;
- b) The Treasurer;
- c) The Secretary General.

Any two signatories shall authorize withdrawals or financial transactions, provided one of them is the Treasurer.

No personal bank account shall be used for Association funds.

Article 27: Assets and Property

All assets and property acquired by the Association shall be the collective property of DeKUT Gikuyu Students Association.

The Executive Committee shall ensure proper custody, maintenance, and protection of all Association assets.

An updated inventory of assets shall be maintained by the Secretary General in collaboration with the Treasurer.

No asset of the Association shall be sold, disposed of, or transferred without approval of the General Assembly and in compliance with University regulations.

CHAPTER SEVEN

MEETINGS

Article 28: Types of Meetings

The Association shall hold the following types of meetings:

- a) General Assembly Meetings;
- b) Executive Committee Meetings;
- c) Special General Meetings;
- d) Committee Meetings.

All meetings shall be conducted in accordance with this Constitution and University regulations.

Article 29: General Assembly Meetings

The General Assembly shall be the highest decision-making forum of the Association.

Ordinary General Assembly meetings shall be held **at least once every month in every academic semester.**

The functions of the General Assembly meetings shall include:

- a) Receiving and deliberating on reports from the Executive Committee;
 - b) Discussing and approving Association programs and policies;
 - c) Approving budgets, financial reports, and major expenditures;
 - d) Electing or removing officials of the Association;
 - e) Addressing matters affecting the welfare of members.
-

Article 30: Special General Meetings

A Special General Meeting may be convened:

- a) By the Chairperson in consultation with the Executive Committee; or
- b) Upon written request by at least one-third of registered members.

The purpose of a Special General Meeting shall be limited to the agenda for which it was convened.

Article 31: Executive Committee Meetings

The Executive Committee shall meet **at least once every month** or as may be necessary for the effective management of the Association.

Executive Committee meetings shall be convened by the Chairperson or, in their absence, the Vice-Chairperson.

The Executive Committee shall deliberate on administrative, financial, and operational matters and implement resolutions of the General Assembly.

Article 32: Notice of Meetings

Notice for meetings shall be issued as follows:

- a) Ordinary General Assembly Meetings – at least **seven (7) days' notice**;
- b) Special General Meetings – at least **forty-eight (48) hours' notice**;
- c) Executive Committee Meetings – at least **twenty-four (24) hours' notice**, unless in cases of urgency.

Notices shall include the date, venue, time, and agenda of the meeting and shall be communicated through official Association communication channels.

Article 33: Quorum

The quorum for meetings shall be as follows:

- a) General Assembly Meetings – **at least one-third (1/3) of registered members;**
- b) Executive Committee Meetings – **at least two-thirds (2/3) of Executive Committee members.**

No official business shall be conducted in the absence of quorum.

Article 34: Chairing of Meetings

Meetings of the Association shall be chaired by:

- a) The Chairperson;
 - b) In the absence of the Chairperson, the Vice-Chairperson;
 - c) In the absence of both, a member elected by those present.
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Article 35: Decision-Making

Decisions in meetings shall be made by **simple majority vote** of members present and voting, unless otherwise provided in this Constitution.

In the event of a tie, the Chairperson or presiding officer shall have a **casting vote**.

Article 36: Minutes and Records

The Secretary General shall record accurate minutes of all meetings of the Association.

Minutes shall be confirmed at the subsequent meeting and kept as official records of the Association.

All confirmed minutes shall be accessible to members upon request.

CHAPTER EIGHT

DISCIPLINE AND CONFLICT RESOLUTION

Article 37: Purpose of Discipline

The purpose of discipline within The DeKUT Gikuyu Students Association shall be to:

- a) Promote order, responsibility, and ethical conduct among members;
 - b) Protect the integrity, reputation, and objectives of the Association;
 - c) Resolve conflicts in a fair, transparent, and peaceful manner;
 - d) Encourage corrective rather than punitive measures where possible.
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Article 38: Disciplinary Authority

Disciplinary authority of the Association shall vest in:

- a) The Executive Committee; and
- b) A Disciplinary Committee appointed by the Executive Committee and approved by the General Assembly, where necessary.

All disciplinary actions shall be consistent with this Constitution and University regulations.

Article 39: Grounds for Disciplinary Action

A member or official of the Association may be subjected to disciplinary action if he or she:

- a) Violates the Constitution, rules, or lawful decisions of the Association;
 - b) Engages in misconduct, indiscipline, or unethical behavior;
 - c) Acts in a manner that brings the Association or the University into disrepute;
 - d) Abuses office or misuses Association resources;
 - e) Incites division, violence, or hostility among members;
 - f) Fails to observe the values and objectives of the Association.
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Article 40: Disciplinary Procedure

The following procedure shall apply in disciplinary matters:

- a) A written complaint stating the alleged misconduct shall be submitted to the Secretary General;
- b) The concerned member shall be notified in writing of the allegations;
- c) The member shall be given a fair opportunity to respond and be heard;
- d) Investigations shall be conducted impartially and within a reasonable time;
- e) A decision shall be communicated in writing, stating the reasons for such decision.

No disciplinary action shall be taken without observing the principles of natural justice and due process.

Article 41: Disciplinary Measures

Disciplinary measures may include:

- a) Verbal or written warning;
- b) Suspension from Association activities for a specified period;
- c) Removal from office, where applicable, in accordance with this Constitution;
- d) Expulsion from the Association, subject to approval by the General Assembly;
- e) Any other corrective measure deemed appropriate and lawful.

The severity of the disciplinary measure shall be proportionate to the misconduct committed.

Article 42: Conflict Resolution

The Association shall encourage amicable resolution of disputes through:

- a) Dialogue and mediation;
- b) Internal arbitration by the Executive Committee or a designated committee;
- c) Traditional conflict resolution values consistent with the spirit of unity and respect.

Where internal mechanisms fail, the matter may be referred to relevant University authorities.

Article 43: Right of Appeal

Any member or official aggrieved by a disciplinary decision shall have the right to appeal.

An appeal shall be lodged in writing to the General Assembly or University authority within **seven (7) days** of the decision.

The decision of the appellate body shall be final, subject to University regulations.

CHAPTER NINE

AMENDMENT OF THE CONSTITUTION

Article 44: Proposal of Amendments

Any proposal to amend this Constitution may be initiated by:

- a) The Executive Committee; or
- b) At least one-third (1/3) of registered members of the Association through a written petition.

All proposed amendments shall be submitted in writing to the Secretary General, clearly stating the provisions to be amended and the justification thereof.

Article 45: Procedure for Amendment

The Secretary General shall circulate the proposed amendments to all members at least **fourteen (14) days** before the General Assembly meeting convened to consider the amendments.

The proposed amendments shall be debated at a duly constituted General Assembly meeting.

An amendment shall only be adopted if approved by a **two-thirds (2/3) majority** of members present and voting.

Article 46: Approval and Effect of Amendments

All approved amendments shall be subject to the rules, regulations, and approval of Dedan Kimathi University of Technology.

Upon approval, the amendments shall take effect immediately and shall form an integral part of this Constitution.

The Secretary General shall ensure that all members are notified of any amendments and that the amended Constitution is properly documented.

CONCLUSION

This Constitution is hereby adopted as the supreme guiding document of DeKUT Gikuyu Student Association.

All members and officials of the Association shall respect, uphold, and defend this Constitution and shall conduct all Association affairs in accordance with its provisions, the rules and regulations of Dedan Kimathi University of Technology, and the laws of the Republic of Kenya.

Through unity, integrity, cultural pride, and responsible leadership, The DeKUT Gikuyu Students Association commits itself to the growth, harmony, and empowerment of its members and to positive contribution within the University and the wider society.